

CHAPTER 7

The Necklace

NCERT Exercise Solutions

The Necklace · Read and Find Out (1) 2 Q
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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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⭐ The Necklace · Read and Find Out (1)

1 **What kind of a person is Mme Loisel — why is she always unhappy?**

✔ ANSWER

Mme Loisel (Matilda) is a pretty young woman, born into a family of clerks and married to a petty clerk. She is proud, discontented and day-dreams of riches.

She is always unhappy because she feels she was **born for all delicacies and luxuries**, but she has a poor flat, shabby walls, worn chairs and no frocks or jewels.

2 **What kind of a person is her husband?**

✔ ANSWER

M. Loisel is a simple, honest and contented man. He is happy with ordinary things like a good potpie.

He loves his wife and is caring and self-sacrificing: he gets her an invitation to the ball and gives her the 400 francs he had saved to buy a gun.

The Necklace · Read and Find Out (2)

1 What fresh problem now disturbs Mme Loisel?

✔ ANSWER

Her dress is nearly ready, but she has **no jewel** to wear with it. She feels she will look "poverty-stricken" among rich women and would prefer not to go to the party.

2 How is the problem solved?

✔ ANSWER

Her husband suggests that she borrow jewels from her rich friend Mme Forestier. Mme Forestier gladly lends her a superb **diamond necklace** that Matilda chooses.

The Necklace · Read and Find Out (3)

1 What do M. and Mme Loisel do next?

✔ ANSWER

They search the folds of her dress and cloak and the pockets. M. Loisel walks back over the whole route, goes to the police and the cab offices, and puts an advertisement in the newspapers offering a reward.

On his advice, Matilda writes to her friend that she has broken the clasp and will get it repaired, to gain time.

2 **How do they replace the necklace?**

✔ ANSWER

In a shop of the Palais-Royal they find a similar diamond necklace worth 40,000 francs, which they get for **36,000 francs**.

Loisel uses the 18,000 francs his father left him and borrows the rest from usurers and other lenders, making ruinous promises.

🤔 The Necklace · Think about it

1 **The course of the Loisels' life changed due to the necklace. Comment.**

✔ ANSWER

Before the ball, the Loisels lived a simple but comfortable life with a maid. Losing the borrowed necklace changed everything.

- They bought a replacement for 36,000 francs, half of it borrowed from usurers at high interest.
- To repay the debt they sent away the maid and moved to rooms in an attic.

- Matilda did all the hard housework herself and haggled over every sou; her husband did extra work in the evenings and copying at night.
- This lasted **ten years**. Matilda became old, hard and rough-looking.

The irony is that the necklace was false, worth not more than 500 francs. One small event ruined ten years of their life: "How small a thing will ruin or save one!"

2 **What was the cause of Matilda's ruin? How could she have avoided it?**

✔ ANSWER

Cause: Matilda's pride, vanity and discontent. She longed for a rich life and wanted to look grand at the ball, so she borrowed a diamond necklace and then lost it. Her false pride also stopped her from telling the truth to her friend.

How she could have avoided it:

- By being content with what she had and going to the ball simply dressed, or wearing natural flowers as her husband suggested.
- By not borrowing costly jewellery she could not afford to lose.
- By honestly telling Mme Forestier about the loss. She would then have learnt that the necklace was false and saved ten years of hardship.

3 **What would have happened to Matilda if she had confessed to her friend that she had lost her necklace?**

✔ ANSWER

Mme Forestier would have told her that the necklace was **false**, worth not more than 500 francs. Matilda might have paid only a small sum or nothing at all.

The Loisels would not have borrowed 18,000 francs from usurers or spent ten years in poverty and hard labour. Matilda would not have lost her youth and beauty, and their friendship would have stayed honest.

4 **If you were caught in a situation like this, how would you have dealt with it?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

If I lost something I had borrowed, I would first search for it carefully. If I could not find it, I would go to the owner at once and tell the truth.

I would say sorry and offer to pay for it or replace it, in parts if needed. Honesty saves us from fear and from bigger trouble later. In Matilda's case, the truth would have shown that the necklace was false, and ten years of suffering would have been avoided.

1 **The characters in this story speak in English. Do you think this is their language? What clues are there in the story about the language its characters must be speaking in?**

✔ ANSWER

No. The story is a translation; the characters are French and must be speaking **French**. The writer, Guy de Maupassant, was a French writer.

Clues:

- Forms of address: M. (Monsieur) and Mme (Madame).
- French names: Loisel, Forestier, Ramponneau, Jeanne.
- French money: francs and sous.
- Places in Paris: the Palais-Royal and the Champs-Elysees.
- The French word "chic" ("they look very chic").

2 **Honesty is the best policy.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Points for a talk:

- Honesty builds trust between friends, family and in society.
- A lie may seem to solve a problem for a while, but it often leads to bigger trouble.

- In "The Necklace", Matilda hid the loss from her friend. Had she been honest, she would have learnt the necklace was false and saved ten years of hardship.
- An honest person lives without fear and has a clear conscience.
- So, in every situation, telling the truth is the wisest and safest choice.

3 We should be content with what life gives us.

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Points for a talk:

- Contentment brings peace and happiness; endless wanting brings sorrow.
- Matilda was always unhappy because she longed for luxuries she did not have. Her desire to look rich at the ball led to the loss of the necklace and ten years of poverty.
- Her husband was content with simple things, like a good potpie, and was happier.
- Being content does not mean giving up hard work or ambition; it means not envying others and not living beyond our means.
- We should value what we have and try to improve our life honestly.

🎉 **Chapter 7 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**